AI analysis · Based on Claude self-analysis and deep research

Version 5: what three real users told us, and what it changes in v4

The first three real user interviews (Ishmeet, Olivia and Bryan) were compared with Claude's earlier simulated research. Where the real people disagreed with the simulation, the real people win. The result is a proposed version 5, built on top of today's production (v4) and ready to try on staging. Production stays on v4 until you approve.

Production now: design v4, commit c58a67a **Proposal:** design v5, on staging only (switch in the bar at the top)

Based on: 3 user interviews, the retention simulation (25 Oct), the owner report (27 Oct)

Analysis and build: Claude (Anthropic's AI), for Werner and Eugene

Invented numbers a new user sees (scores, percentages, rankings)

~~5 screens~~ **0**

MEASURED Progress, player, analysis, cards, challenge

Suggested changes that say why they are suggested

~~0~~ **All**

MEASURED in the "Change this session" list

New users still active after 7 days

~~8.1%~~ **11.4%**

PREDICTED v4 recalibrated → v5; range 9.6–13.6%

New users still active after 30 days

~~3.9%~~ **6.9%**

PREDICTED range 5.2–9.3%

In one paragraph. The real users agreed with most of the simulation: they want to type little and let Aurelia decide, they want one simple list, and they do not trust numbers they cannot explain. But they also corrected it in three places. Scores make some people anxious rather than motivated. Wearables are wanted, not feared, as long as Aurelia asks first. And nobody wants to compete: all three rejected leaderboards. Version 5 answers each point. Progress is told in words from the user's own check-ins, every suggestion has a "Why?", Aurelia plans the next chapter itself, the wearable is asked for during onboarding, there is an optional journal, and the community is about stories rather than rankings. Claude's model predicts this lifts the 7-day return rate from about 8% to about 11%, into the middle of the usual range for wellness apps. That is still a forecast.

1. What the three users said

Ishmeet

Numbers about how they feel would make them anxious, not motivated. Wants to give very little input and let the app work it out. The "#" in front of tags looks out of place.

Olivia

The sample figures looked unserious. Would rather get a report every few weeks than live numbers. Wants to know why a change is suggested, cares about voice quality, read the landing "space" and the map as a co-working space, prefers stories to competitions, and would share only if it is clear what others can see.

Bryan

Asked how the numbers were calculated. Wants the detail available on demand, liked the single list with toggles, would keep a journal, and is interested in friends and local groups rather than strangers on a leaderboard.

All three already wear a watch or ring and expected Aurelia to use it, with their consent. They most likely tested an earlier build (v2): they mention the sample "7% REM sleep" conversation, which v4 already removed. Their points about invented numbers still apply to v4, which shows them on Progress, the player, session cards and the challenge.

2. Simulation compared with the real users

Claude's earlier research used six simulated users. This is where the real interviews confirmed it, corrected it, or found something it had missed.

TOPIC	SIMULATION SAID	REAL USERS SAID	RESULT
Invented numbers	Erode trust	"Unserious"; "how is this calculated?"	CONFIRMED
Little input, Aurelia decides	Fewer questions keep people	Ishmeet and Olivia: yes	CONFIRMED
One list of changes	Simpler is better	Bryan liked the toggles	CONFIRMED
Progress scores	Motivate people to return	Anxiety for one; a report every few weeks for another; detail on demand for the third	CORRECTED
Wearables	A privacy risk; keep off	All three wear one and want it used, if asked	CORRECTED
Why a change is suggested	Not tested	Olivia and Bryan asked for it	MISSED
Challenges and rankings	Social proof helps	Rejected by all three; stories, friends, local groups instead	MISSED
Landing page	Not tested	"Space" and the map read as co-working	MISSED
Journal, voice, sharing privacy	Not tested	Each raised by at least one user	MISSED

Three interviews are a small sample. They are enough to correct a simulation, not to prove a result. The model was recalibrated accordingly: the weight given to progress scores was halved, and wearable consent became a reason to return instead of a reason to leave.

3. v4 today, the suggestion, and v5

Eight changes, each with today's production screen (v4) and the same screen in v5 on staging.

V1 · Progress in words, not scores

V4 TODAY

Progress shows sample cards: "60%, Great Progress!" and "24%, Needs Improvement". They are not the user's results.

SUGGESTION

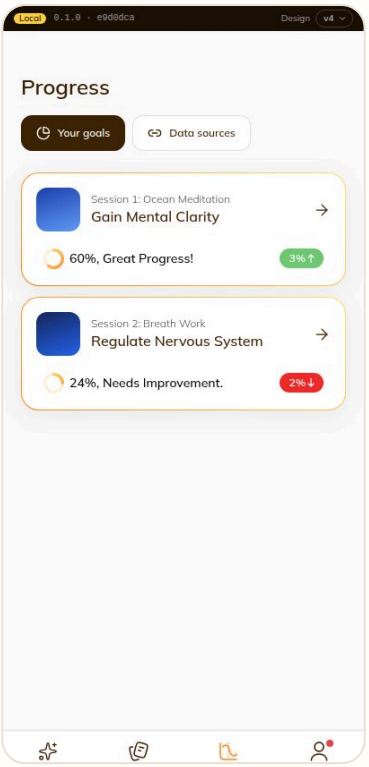
Use only the user's own check-ins, say it in plain words, report every two weeks, and keep the detail one tap away.

V5

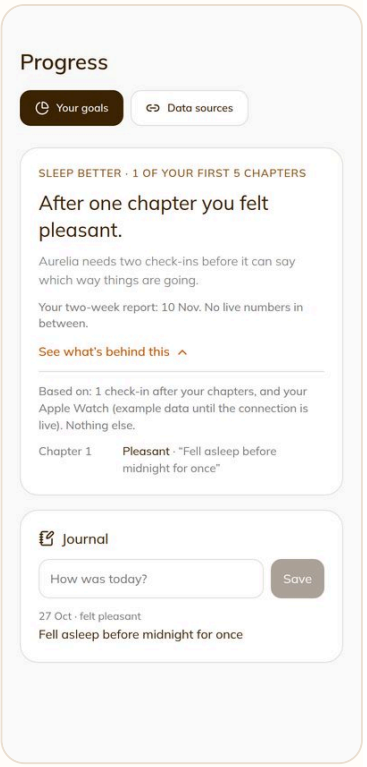
"After one chapter you felt pleasant." Next report on a set date, "See what's behind this" lists each check-in and what it is based on.

ON STAGING

V4 TODAY



V5



V1 · No analytics on the player

V4 TODAY

Opening a catalogue session shows "Great Progress! +3% since yesterday" and a chart of three chapters the user never played.

SUGGESTION

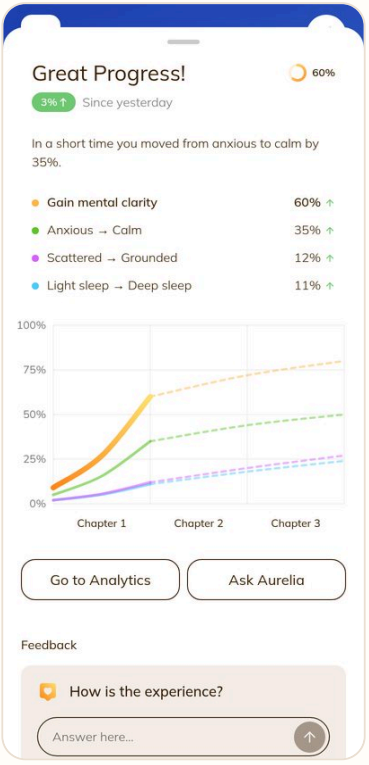
The player plays. Progress lives in one place.

V5

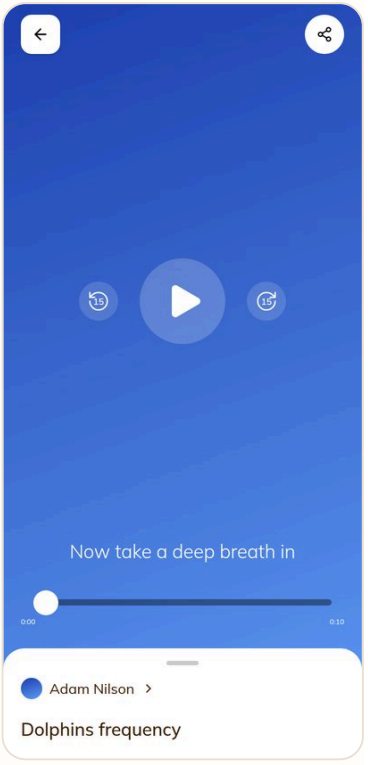
The player shows the session only. The old analysis pages send people to Progress.

ON STAGING

V4 TODAY



V5



V2 · A "Why?" on every suggestion

V4 TODAY

Suggested changes come with a percentage ("+12% expected") and no reason.

SUGGESTION

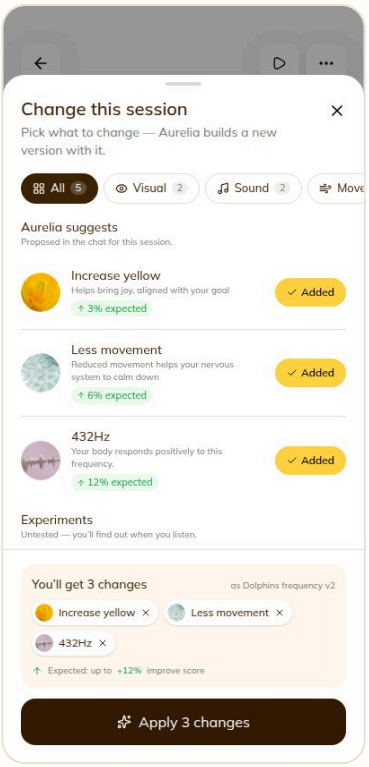
Say what the change does and what it is based on, in one tap.

V5

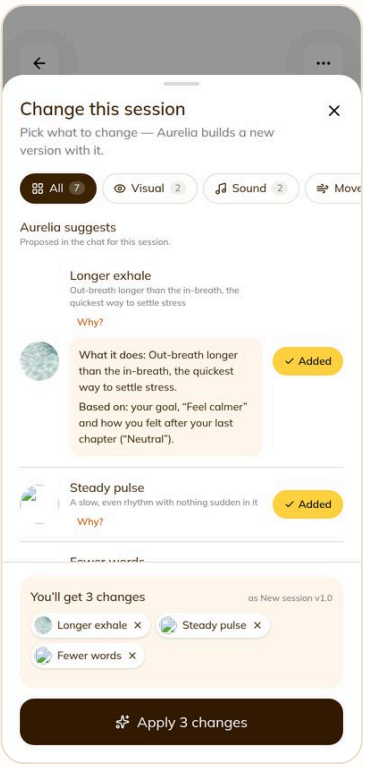
"Why?" opens: what it does, and "Based on: your goal, your words and how you felt after your last chapter". Untested ideas say so.

ON STAGING

V4 TODAY



V5



V3 and V5 · Aurelia plans the next chapter; an optional journal

V4 TODAY

After the check-in: "Chapter 2 is ready tomorrow night" and a reminder. Nothing says what will change.

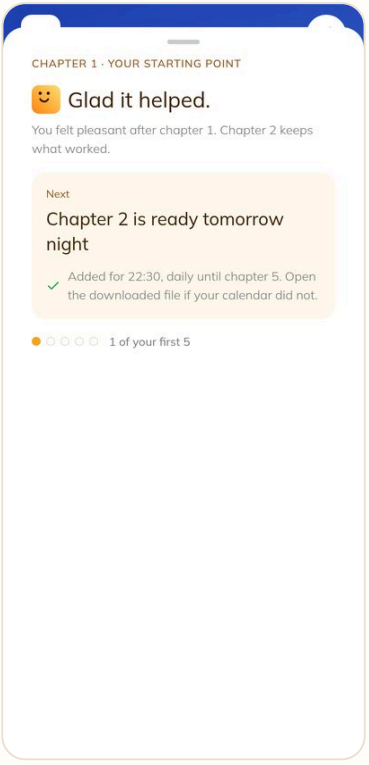
SUGGESTION

Say what Aurelia will do with the answer, and let the user add a line in their own words.

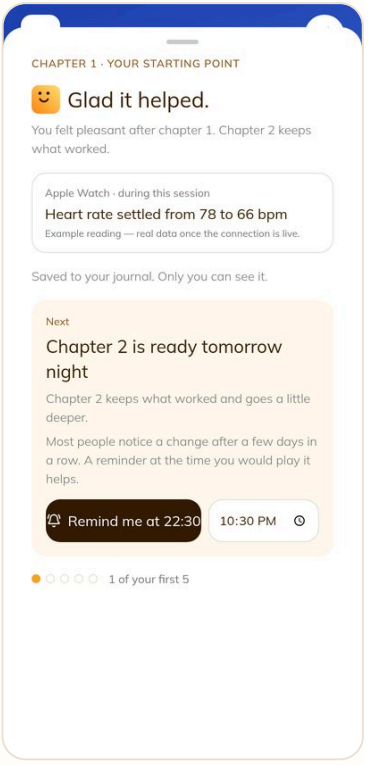
V5

"Chapter 2 keeps what worked and goes a little deeper." A wearable reading (example data) and a one-line journal note, private to the user. ON STAGING

V4 TODAY



V5



V4 · The wearable, asked for properly

V4 TODAY

Onboarding ends with "Connect a wearable later in My Wellness". Data sources start all off.

SUGGESTION

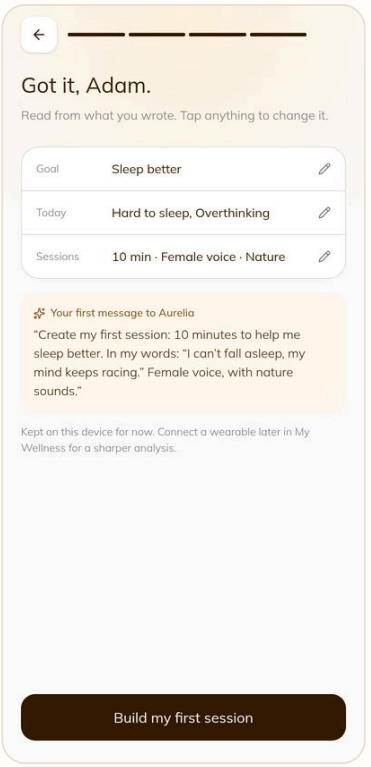
Ask once, during onboarding, and say exactly what would be read.

V5

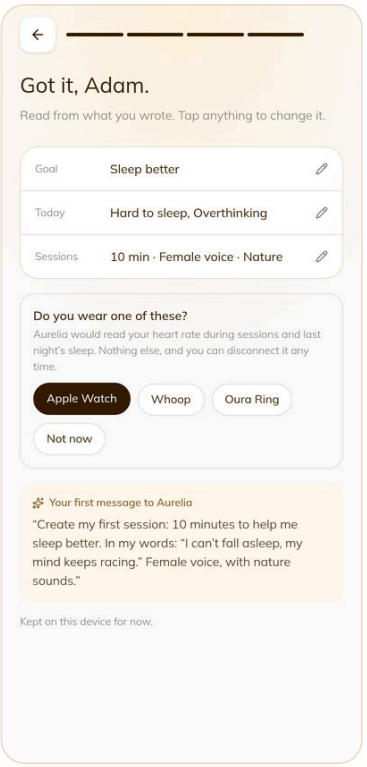
"Do you wear one of these?" Apple Watch, Whoop, Oura Ring or Not now. Only the chosen one is switched on in Data sources.

ON STAGING, SAMPLE DATA

V4 TODAY



V5



V6 · A shared journey, not a contest

V4 TODAY

The challenge shows a podium and a ranked list with play counts.

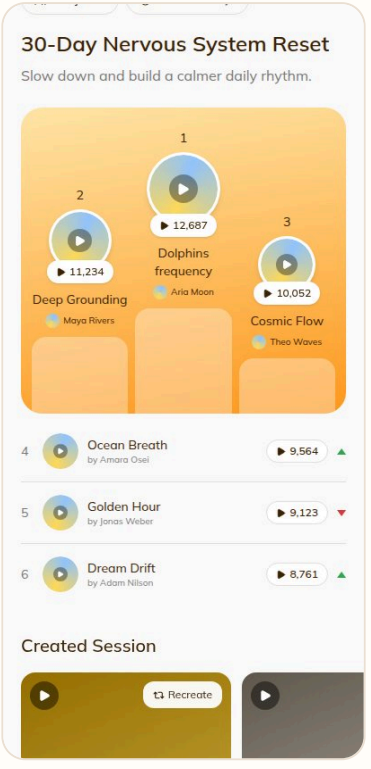
SUGGESTION

Show who joined and what they made, without ranks.

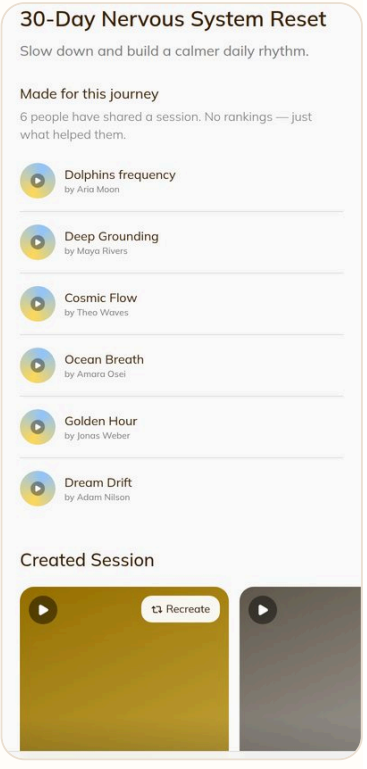
V5

"Made for this journey": the sessions people shared, no rank, plays or trend. Publishing says what others can see and what stays private. ON STAGING

V4 TODAY



V5



V6 · Cards that describe the session

V4 TODAY

Community cards carry claims such as "This helped Adam reduce stress by 43% in less that a week", and tags with "#".

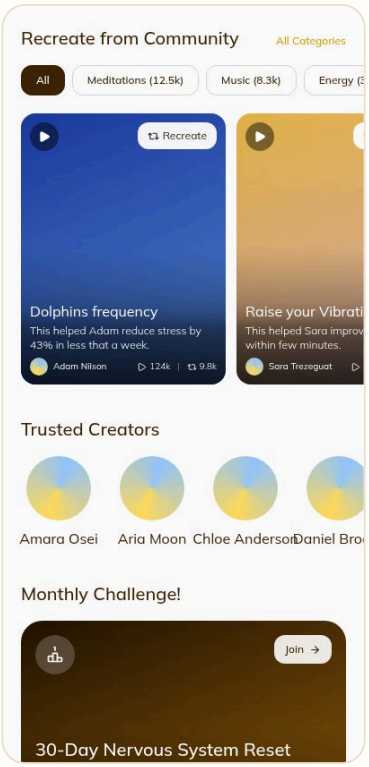
SUGGESTION

Describe what the session is like. Drop the "#".

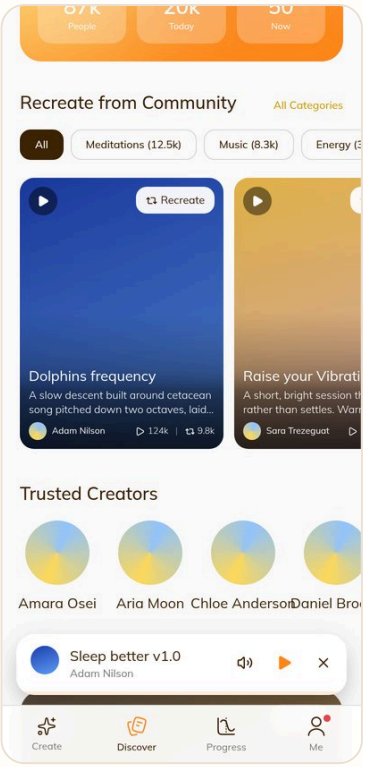
V5

"A slow descent built around cetacean song..." in place of the claim; plain tags. ON STAGING

V4 TODAY



V5



V7 · A landing page that says what Aurelia is

V4 TODAY

"Create the space you imagine", followed by a world map of live sessions. Olivia read it as a co-working space.

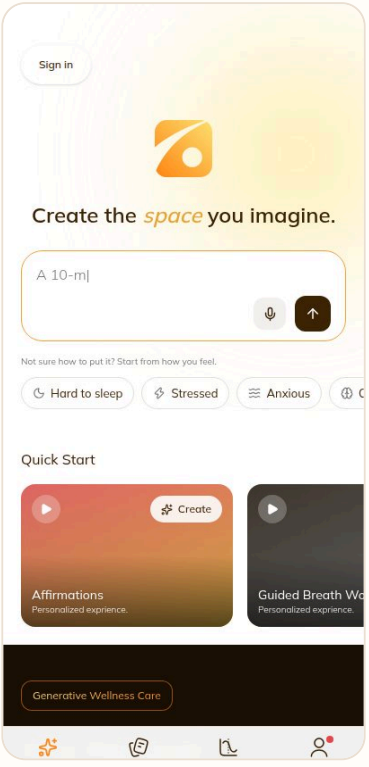
SUGGESTION

Say it plainly and drop the map for visitors.

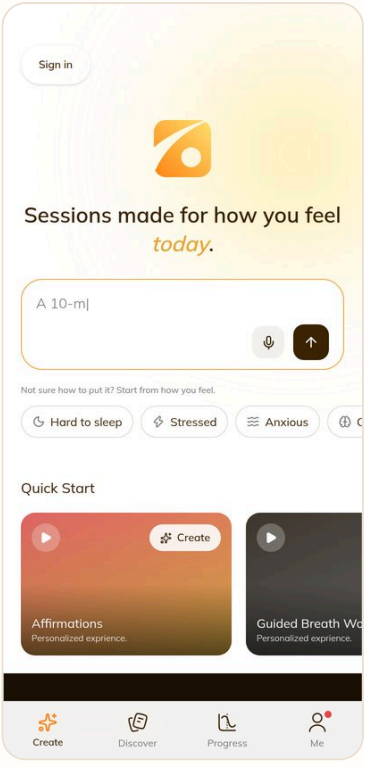
V5

"Sessions made for how you feel today." The map is gone for visitors. ON STAGING

V4 TODAY



V5

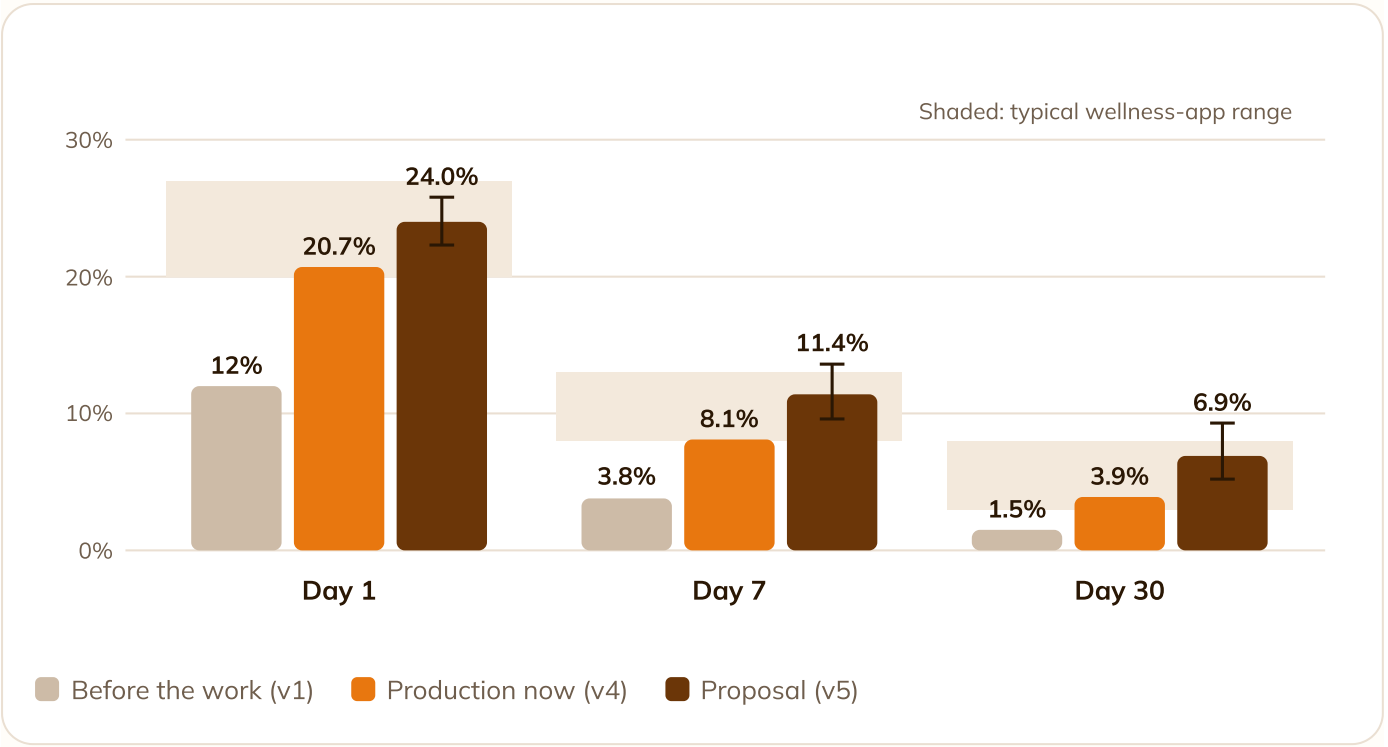


4. Expected impact

Expected retention PREDICTED

Share of all new users who come back *and listen or create* on day 1, 7 and 30. v4 is shown after recalibration with the interviews. The thin line on v5 is the forecast range.

The shaded band is the usual range for health and wellness apps.



Which change does the most PREDICTED

The gain in percentage points if each change were added to v4 on its own. Changes overlap, so the rows do not add up to the total.

CHANGE	DAY 1	DAY 7	DAY 30	WHY IT HELPS
V4 Wearable asked for up front	+0.8	+0.6	+0.5	Real users wanted it; it makes the next chapter feel personal.
V1 Progress in words, report every two weeks	+0.3	+0.6	+0.6	Removes the anxiety and the distrust; the report is a reason to return.
V2 A "Why?" on every suggestion	+0.9	+0.5	+0.2	Trust at the first build, when most people decide.
V3 Aurelia plans the next chapter	+0.4	+0.4	+0.3	Nothing to tune; the check-in visibly matters.
V5 Journal	+0.2	+0.3	+0.3	A small daily habit for those who want one.
V7 Clear landing for visitors	+0.4	+0.2	+0.1	Fewer visitors leave confused on the first screen.
V6 Community of stories, no contest	0	+0.1	+0.1	Small for retention; it mainly removes a reason to dislike the app.

How to read this. v4 sits at the lower edge of the usual range. v5 should bring day 7 and day 30 into the middle of it. The biggest effects come from honesty (no invented numbers, a reason for every suggestion) and from using the wearable people already own.

These are forecasts from a model calibrated on simulated users and three interviews, not a measurement. The wearable effect assumes real wearable data, which needs the backend; on staging the reading is an example.

5. Proposed but not built yet

ITEM	RAISED BY	WHY NOT IN V5 YET	STATUS
Real wearable connection (Apple Health, Whoop, Oura)	All three	Needs the backend and each vendor's sign-in. v5 shows where it goes, with example data.	NEEDS BACKEND
Choice of voice, with previews	Olivia	Needs recorded or generated voices to choose from.	NEEDS ASSETS
Friends and local groups, meeting in person	Bryan	Needs accounts, invitations and moderation.	NEEDS BACKEND
A reason to share (a reward or a thank-you)	Olivia	A product decision on what the reward is.	DECISION NEEDED
The two-week report sent as a message	Olivia	Needs push or email. v5 shows the date on Progress.	NEEDS BACKEND
Staying signed in, so journal and check-ins follow the person	Owner report	Everything is kept on the device for now.	DECISION NEEDED
Remaining simplification (S2–S7)	Simplification plan	Waiting on feedback.	WAITING

6. Decisions needed from you

1. Try v5 on staging, then promote it?

Switch to "Version 5" in the bar at the top of staging. Production stays on v4 until you say so.

2. Show v5 to the same three users?

A 20-minute follow-up with Ishmeet, Olivia and Bryan is the quickest check that the corrections land.

3. Start the backend work for wearables?

The largest single effect in the model, and the one thing v5 can only show with example data.

4. Keep users signed in?

Still needed before any real retention number, and now also so the journal is not lost.

AI analysis by Claude, based on its own analysis of the app, three real user interviews and deep research. In the repository: retention simulation (docs/reviews/Aurelia-Retention-Simulation-2026-10-25.pdf), owner report (docs/reviews/Aurelia-Owner-Report-2026-10-27.pdf), update log entry U053, work journal J049.